

FRONTION NEWS

Strategic Brief

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Hormuz Talks Resume Under Ultimatum, Spain's Deadliest Wildfire in Decades, Typhoon Bavi Menaces East Asia

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The Bottom Line

The US-Iran standoff over Hormuz has entered a new phase: talks will resume Saturday in Oman, but only under an American ultimatum that Iran publicly declare the strait open and stop firing on ships. Iran's private admission that the attacks were a 'mistake' gives both sides a face-saving path, but whether Tehran can — or will — deliver on a public commitment remains the open question. Meanwhile, two climate-driven crises are unfolding simultaneously: Spain's deadliest wildfire in decades has killed at least 12 with 23 missing, and Typhoon Bavi — one of the largest storms to hit East Asia in decades — is bearing down on Taiwan and China after killing 15 in the Philippines and on the heels of Typhoon Maysak, which killed 39. In Washington, Trump has emptied the federal election commission four months before midterms, leveraging a recent Supreme Court ruling expanding presidential removal power. And China's first reusable rocket landing marks a meaningful step in the strategic competition for access to space.